

2016. The minimum academic marks required for eligibility were relaxed, and the family income cap was increased from ₹2.5 lakh to ₹4 lakh per annum, thus opening a broad window of opportunity for more meritorious students from low-income backgrounds.

Further strengthening its commitment to education, the government extended the scheme from 2021–22 academic session beyond SC and BC communities to include other deprived students from Haryana. This inclusive step ensures that no deserving student is left behind due to social identity or financial limitations.

Through these well-structured interventions, the Haryana Government is not only offering financial support, it is also providing dignity, opportunity, and a chance for every citizen to hold his head high. With policy reforms grounded in empathy and inclusivity, the state is shaping a future where progress is shared and no community feels left behind.

MORE COMMUNITIES ADDED TO SC LIST

The state has also added communities like Aheria, Aheri, Hari, Heri, Thori, Turi, and Rai Sikh to the Scheduled Castes list of Haryana. This strategic inclusion enables these communities to access reserved quotas in education, employment, and government schemes designed to address historical disadvantages.

One of the most impactful legal reforms introduced this year is the Haryana Backward Classes (Reservation in Services and Educational Institutions) Amendment Act, 2024. With this legislation, the state has updated its framework on reservations, ensuring that benefits are delivered fairly.

Further expanding the inclusivity agenda, the state issued new guidelines on July 16, 2024 for the promotion of individuals from backward classes, in line with directives from the Central Government. This move is expected to enhance mobility and representation of backward class individuals in various public sectors across the state.

VIMUKT GHUMANTU JATI VIKAS BOARD

Recognising the unique challenges faced by the nomadic and semi- nomadic tribes, the government established the Haryana Vimukt Ghumantu Jati Vikas Board—a dedicated body for the integrated development of such tribes.

The government has also prioritised skill development with the establishment of the Haryana Kaushal Vikas Board, aimed at improving employment opportunities through vocational training and capacity building.

In a landmark step towards safeguarding the rights and dignity of sanitation workers, the Haryana State Safai Karamchari Commission has been formed. This commission is expected to play a key role in resolving issues faced by sanitation workers, ensuring occupational safety, legal protections, and welfare support. In order to reinforce legal protections and promote the welfare of Scheduled Castes, the state has set up the Haryana State Scheduled Castes Commission. The body is tasked with safeguarding the constitutional and legal rights of SC communities, addressing grievances, and ensuring better implementation of the welfare schemes.

The state has also demonstrated its commitment to inclusivity through policy adjustments. On February 16, 2016, the Garhi Lohar community was included in the Tapriwas category, making them eligible for various state welfare schemes. This inclusion opened access to essential support systems previously unavailable to the community.

AIDING THE NEEDY

₹71,000
for SC/ST brides

₹80,000
in self-employment aid

₹2.5
lakh for inter-caste marriages

Up to **₹8.25 lakh**
compensation for atrocity victims

₹4 lakh
income cap for scholarships

₹22,000
for legal aid